

THIS IS TECHNOLOGY, CULTURE AND SCIENCE WITH A DIFFERENCE, AND THAT DIFFERENCE IS USUALLY ENOUGH TO MAKE MOST NORMAL PEOPLE GO "WTF?"

This month in ALT:

In Geek-Key, we explore a couple of fictional cities that exist in films, games, and other pop culture, in 1000 words, we delve into some fake Museum relics, and in Hot or Not, we go over some popular trends.



Godel's theorems

An exploration of how Godel managed to prove that it is impossible to ever find a complete and consistent set of axioms for all mathematics, a property that seems to be extending to physics and reality. The proof removed the foundation under mathematics.

<https://dgit.in/godel>

WHAT'S NEW

How to topple a statue

Following the killing of George Floyd, people across the world have been protesting the lasting legacy of racism by topping the statues of known racists. You never know when you might have to take down a monument that should not have been put up in the first place. For this reason, scientists have put together a guide that explains the best methods that can be used to topple a statue, without causing injury to anyone. The most important thing to note is that the statues are not solid, and are actually made up of thin metal sheets. It might be necessary to get together a crew of about 70 people to pull at the ropes, or get a good sized vehicle. If the statue is mounted on a base, split



into two teams, and go for a tug of war approach. Either way, it is necessary to weaken the statue first, and this can

be done with the application of heat, for which a butane torch is ideally suited. Then you have to use the Pythagorean theorem to make sure that when the statue falls, it does not do so on one of the people tugging the rope. Obviously, the first person on the rope has to be at a distance that is greater than the height of the statue.

<https://dgit.in/tplsttu>

Autopsy of the Twitter Bitcoin hack

In mid July, a number of high profile Twitter accounts were compromised, and started sending out links to bitcoin scams. An analysis of the bitcoin wallet showed that the hackers amassed 13 BTC in one day, the price of which is ₹90,86,180 (at the time of writing). Twitter gave a blow by blow account of how it was tackling the breach. The hackers used social engineering approaches to gain access to the backend tools. This intrusion



was without direct access to the passwords of the affected accounts, just the tools used by Twitter themselves. The tweets were deleted, and the affected users did not need to reset their passwords. An

investigation by KerbsOnSecurity showed that it was some shady members of the SIM swapping community. While the hack was ongoing, another twitter account posted screenshots of the tools used by Twitter, which were promptly scrubbed from the platform. The security researchers also go on to identify a potential culprit, PlugWalkJoe, a notorious SIM swapper.

<https://dgit.in/twtrhck>



Hawking's Zingers

Stephen Hawking may be remembered for his theories on black holes, but he was also quick with his wit. Here are some of the famous, witty replies he has given to impossible questions, including ones such as the cosmological implications of Zayn Malik leaving One Direction.

<https://dgit.in/hkfn>



What bird are you?

Ornithologists from Cornell have put together a quiz where you get to answer a series of questions about your personality, and in the end you are provided with one bird that you most resemble. You can share the results on social media, and this test is backed by science!

<https://dgit.in/birdu>



Best ambient albums

While they started off as background tracks that you do not need to pay attention to, ambient music has grown a lot since the creation of the genre by Brian Eno, and Pitchfork has put together a handy list of the best albums, with Spotify and Apple Music playlists included.

<https://dgit.in/ambest>